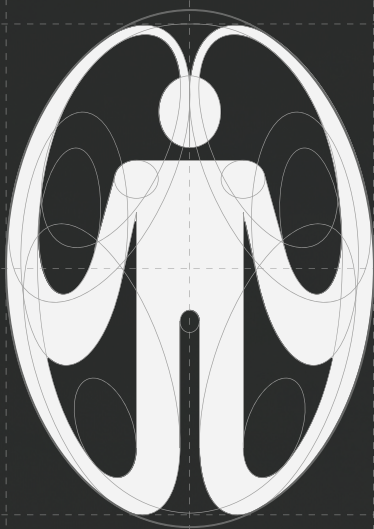




CTRL ONE BASIC OPERATION GUIDE
1ST EDITION
SERIAL No. 10001

HOW TO USE 8 INTERVENTIONS FOR
AN ATTENTION YOU NO LONGER
CONTROL

User manual

BUTTER BUN

PHYSICAL FRICTION
IN THE AUTOMATIC
GRIP LOOP

WHAT IT IS

Butter Bun is a phone case made from a material that reacts to the heat and pressure of your hand. The longer you hold it, the more it swells. It doesn't block the screen. It doesn't restrict access. It simply grows in your grip—slowly and gradually—until holding it starts to feel exactly like what it is: too much.

No timer. No notification. No message telling you to put it down. Just a case that responds to the one thing that's always there when you're using your phone compulsively: your hand.

The longer you have it, the harder it is to ignore that you have it.

Butter Bun doesn't interfere with your behavior. It makes your behavior physical.



FIG.56



WHY IT WORKS

Compulsive phone use occurs in a state of low physical awareness. The hand holds the device on autopilot. The grip is automatic, effortless, invisible to conscious attention. That invisibility is part of what sustains the behavior: the body isn't sending any signal that something has changed.

Butter Bun introduces a physical signal where there was none. As the case expands, the grip changes—the hand has to adjust, reposition itself, and compensate. That adjustment is small, but it is real and continuous. It activates proprioceptive awareness: the body's ability to register its own position and physical state. A grip that requires attention is no longer an automatic grip. And a grip that is no longer automatic is a moment of awareness.

ANATOMY OF THE OBJECT

Butter Bun is a case like any other in terms of fit and protection. Nothing about its appearance suggests that it behaves any differently.

What sets it apart is its material: a thermally activated shape-memory elastomer—a soft polymer designed to gradually expand under the sustained heat of body temperature and return to its original shape as it cools. At rest—on a table, in a pocket, out of your hand—the case remains flat and compact. As soon as you hold it, the material begins to absorb heat and slowly expands.

The expansion is gradual, not abrupt. There's no click, no moment when the case suddenly transforms. It expands just like a long session does: slowly, until you notice it. When you put down your phone and the case cools, it returns to its original shape. Ready for the next time.

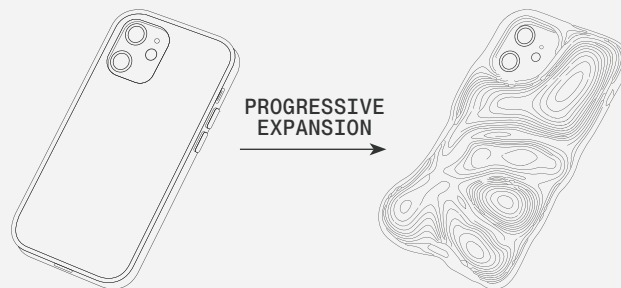


FIG.57

HOW TO USE IT

Butter Bun requires no setup, no activation, no decision. You use your phone. The case does the rest.

STEP 1 FIT THE CASE

Attach Butter Bun to your phone as you would any standard case. That is the only action required of you. From this point, the case operates on its own.

STEP 2 USE THE PHONE AS NORMAL

Calls, messages, scrolling. Butter Bun does not interfere with how you use the device. The screen is fully accessible. Nothing is blocked. In the first moments of use, you will notice no difference.

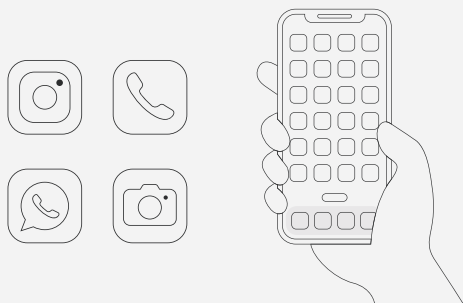


FIG.58

STEP 3 THE CASE BEGINS TO EXPAND

As your hand warms the material, the case slowly grows. The change is subtle at first – a slight increase in volume, a shift in how the device sits in your palm. You may not notice it immediately. That is intentional: Butter Bun does not announce itself. It accumulates.

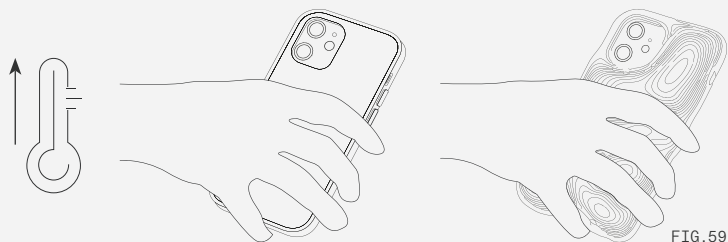


FIG.59



Discomfort is not punishment.
It is information.

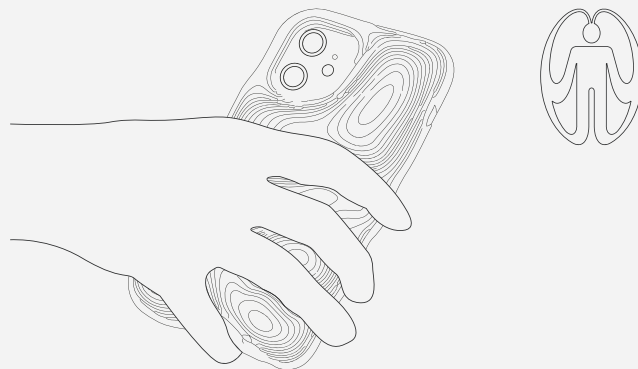


FIG.60

STEP 4 THE GRIP BECOMES CONSCIOUS

At some point – there is no fixed threshold, it depends on your hand and how long you have been holding it – the case becomes difficult to ignore. Not impossible to hold. Not painful. Just present. Your hand has to work a little harder. Your grip is no longer automatic.

STEP 5 PUT THE PHONE DOWN

You do not have to. Butter Bun does not force anything. But the case has made the act of holding the phone visible – physically, in your hand – in a way it was not before. What you do with that is yours.

STEP 6 THE CASE RESETS

When you put the phone down, the material cools and gradually returns to its original shape. No manual reset needed. The next time you pick it up, the process begins again from zero.

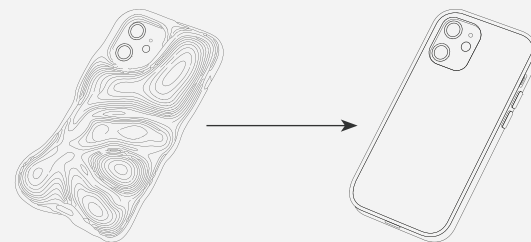


FIG.61

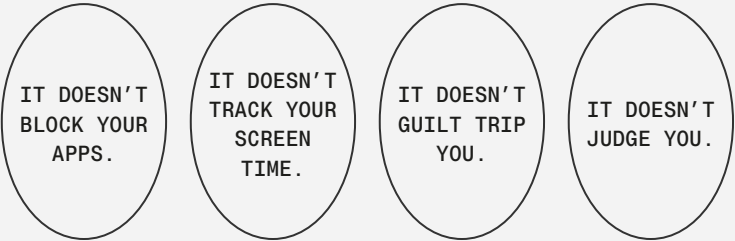
WHEN TO USE IT

Always. Butter Bun is a case – it lives on the phone. It does not distinguish between intentional use and compulsive use. It simply responds to contact. Every session that goes on longer than you meant it to will accumulate in the material.

Its effect is most relevant precisely in the sessions you do not notice: the scroll that started as a two-minute break and is now twenty, the phone picked up out of habit with nothing specific to do. Those are the sessions where the hand is most on autopilot – and where a physical signal has the most work to do.

WHAT BUTTER BUN DOESN'T DO

Butter Bun doesn't stop you from using your phone.



It also does not make prolonged use impossible. You can hold an expanded Butter Bun for as long as you want. The case creates discomfort, not restriction.

The decision to stop (or not)
remains entirely yours.

CURRENT LIMITATION

Shape memory elastomers exist today in laboratory and early industrial form, but not in a consumer-ready version that meets Butter Bun's requirements. The challenge breaks down into three parts.

Response calibration: current shape memory polymers are engineered for precision transitions at a defined temperature – they switch between two states rather than expanding gradually. Butter Bun requires a material that responds continuously and proportionally across the range of sustained hand contact, not one that snaps.



Cycle durability: a phone case expands and contracts many times a day, every day. Existing shape memory elastomers degrade in expansion range and response speed after repeated thermal cycles. No material on the market today maintains consistent behavior across the thousands of cycles daily use would require.

Tactile range: the expansion needs to be perceptible without being dramatic – enough to shift grip awareness, not enough to make the phone unwieldy. Tuning that range across different hand sizes and grip strengths remains an unsolved material design problem.

Too puffy to handle



FIG. 62